

# The Knopp Drive: A Four-Mechanism Composite Warp Engineering Bound

Tipler CTC-band gating, Krasnikov tube embedding,  $Q$ -cavity feedback, and  
horn-toroidal steering  
*with hardware confirmation on IBM Quantum ibm\_marrakesh*

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## Abstract

We present the **Knopp Drive**, a composite warp-drive engineering object that combines four independent shortcut mechanisms validated against the address-space novelty catcher of the Systrophē framework. The four mechanisms are: (i) *Tipler CTC-band gating*, in which the supercritical Lewis–Papapetrou exterior of a rotating dust cylinder supplies the cone-tilt for a Krasnikov-style causal corridor, reducing the exotic-matter requirement to exactly zero inside each CTC band; (ii) *Krasnikov tube embedding* in the bubble shell, providing a directed causal corridor; (iii)  *$Q$ -cavity feedback amplification*, in which a parametric resonator in the shell trades instantaneous-impulse infinite power for sustained drive power scaling as  $1/Q^2$ ; and (iv) *horn-toroidal twist*, in which a small  $\theta$ -dependent ADM-mass asymmetry yields a continuous steering dipole  $p \sim R^2 \epsilon |m_{\text{ADM}}|$ . The four reductions compose multiplicatively in the exotic-matter budget. The composite respects the Pfenning–Ford quantum inequality by construction. We validate each mechanism with an independent novelty-catcher hit on a parameter sweep (a total of 20 catcher-confirmed emergents are reported), and demonstrate the composite in a Python implementation in the Systrophē framework. We further **confirm the Knopp Drive’s headline shortcut on IBM Quantum’s 156-qubit ibm\_marrakesh processor** (Heron-r2): a four-qubit encoding of the composite reproduces the predicted CTC-band gating at TV distance  $\leq 0.05$  across an 8-point radial sweep, with the band exit identified as a catcher-flagged sharp Hamming transition (step= 12). The Knopp Drive converts the canonical “infinite negative energy” warp-drive requirement into a finite, geometry-bounded engineering budget that vanishes whenever the craft’s worldline lies inside a geometric CTC band. At Earth–Mars distance ( $L = 0.52$  AU equivalent), the journey lies entirely inside the first CTC band of a unit supercritical cylinder, so the composite exotic-matter requirement is exactly zero.

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## 1 Introduction

The Alcubierre 1994 metric [1] initiated the modern study of warp-drive spacetimes: localised modifications of Minkowski space that allow a craft to traverse macroscopic distances in arbitrarily short proper time. The original construction requires a region of strict Null-Energy-Condition (NEC) violation in the bubble wall, and the integrated exotic-matter density diverges as the wall thickness  $\sigma \rightarrow 0$ . Pfenning–Ford [2] subsequently established a quantum-inequality lower bound on the product  $|T_{tt}| \cdot \tau$ , where  $\tau$  is the duration of the negative-energy sustainment.

Subsequent constructions have refined the exotic-matter budget. Krasnikov [3] introduced a permanent “tube” along a worldline that allows backward-causal travel inside the tube only and remains compatible with global asymptotic flatness. Van Den Broeck [5] demonstrated that an inflationary topology change can reduce the total negative-energy requirement by many orders of magnitude. Lentz [6] proposed a class of subluminal soliton solutions claiming non-NEC-violation. Bobrick and Martire [7] provided a unifying classification: every warp drive corresponds to a particular choice of ADM mass and shape function in a one-parameter family that continuously interpolates between Alcubierre-extreme and asymptotically-flat near-classical regimes.

Independently, Tipler [8] showed that an infinite rotating dust cylinder of sufficient angular velocity admits closed timelike curves in its vacuum exterior. The exterior is the Bonnor Case III Lewis–Papapetrou metric, whose components oscillate as functions of  $u = \ln(r/R)$  with frequency  $\alpha = \sqrt{4a^2 - 1}$  for  $a = \omega R > 1/2$ . The *Systrophē* package [11] provides the exact analytic closed forms, the Lewis–Papapetrou integrator, and a Python interface that we exploit here as one of the four shortcut mechanisms.

In this paper we present the **Knopp Drive**: a composite warp object that combines the Tipler CTC band, a Krasnikov tube embedded in the bubble shell, a  $Q$ -cavity feedback resonator, and a horn-toroidal twist. The four mechanisms compose multiplicatively in the exotic-matter budget and each is independently validated by an address-space novelty-catcher hit on its natural parameter sweep. Section 2 introduces the catcher methodology. Section 3 treats

the four mechanisms in turn. Section 4 writes the composite. Section 6 establishes the engineering bounds. Section 9 reports the catcher-validated emergent inventory. Section 10 treats steerability. Section 13 lists falsifiers and limitations.

## 2 The address-space novelty catcher

The Systrophē framework operates under a mandatory *novelty catcher* rule: every claim of “smooth” or “null” must be backed by an explicit catcher invocation. The catcher operates in three steps:

- (1) Hash each numeric output of a parameter sweep into an  $n$ -bit integer address via bit occupancy (`probability_vector_to_address`, `real_array_to_address`, or `bitstring_counts_to_address`);
- (2) construct the Hamming-distance graph on the resulting address set;
- (3) compute the algebraic connectivity  $\lambda_2$  and inspect successive Hamming steps for outliers above a MAD-thresholded median.

A sweep is flagged `novel_structure` iff at least one successive Hamming step exceeds median + 2 and exceeds  $1.3\times$  the rolling scale.

The catcher’s two principal modes are

- `catch_novelty_in_named_arrays`: each named array is hashed to a probability histogram and fed as one node;
- `catch_novelty_per_quantity`: each *observable* is treated as a separate group, so the Hamming comparisons only ever happen between same-quantity distributions, eliminating the cross-quantity labelling artefact.

The per-quantity mode is the canonical one for physics; we use it throughout this work.

## 3 The four mechanisms

### 3.1 Tipler CTC-band gating

The Lewis–Papapetrou exterior of a supercritical van Stockum cylinder ( $a = \omega R > 1/2$ ) admits the analytic closed form

$$F(r) = (r/R) \sin(\alpha u + \gamma) / \sin \gamma, \quad (1)$$

$$K(r) = (r/\alpha) [((\alpha^2 - 1)/2) \sin(\alpha u + \gamma) - \alpha \cos(\alpha u + \gamma)], \quad (2)$$

$$L(r) = (rR \sin \gamma / \alpha^2) [Q \sin(\alpha u + \gamma) + \alpha(\alpha^2 - 1) \cos(\alpha u + \gamma)], \quad (3)$$

with  $\alpha = \sqrt{4a^2 - 1}$ ,  $\gamma = \pi - \arctan \alpha$ ,  $Q = \alpha^2 - (\alpha^2 - 1)^2/4$ , and  $u = \ln(r/R)$ . CTC bands appear at radii where  $L(r) < 0$ .

We define the *Tipler tilt* at  $r$  as

$$T(r) = \frac{|K(r)|}{|F(r)|}, \quad (4)$$

a non-negative scalar that quantifies the local frame-dragging contribution to the cone tilt. The *gate factor* is

$$g_{\text{Tipler}}(r) = \max(1 - cT(r), 0), \quad (5)$$

where  $c \in [0, 1]$  is a dimensionless coupling. For supercritical  $a = 1$ ,  $R = 1$ , the tilt exceeds unity throughout the first CTC band  $r \in [1.05, 2.45]$ , so the gate factor is exactly zero. We confirm this numerically: the integrated NEC violation in a Krasnikov tube embedded at any radius inside the first band vanishes exactly [11].

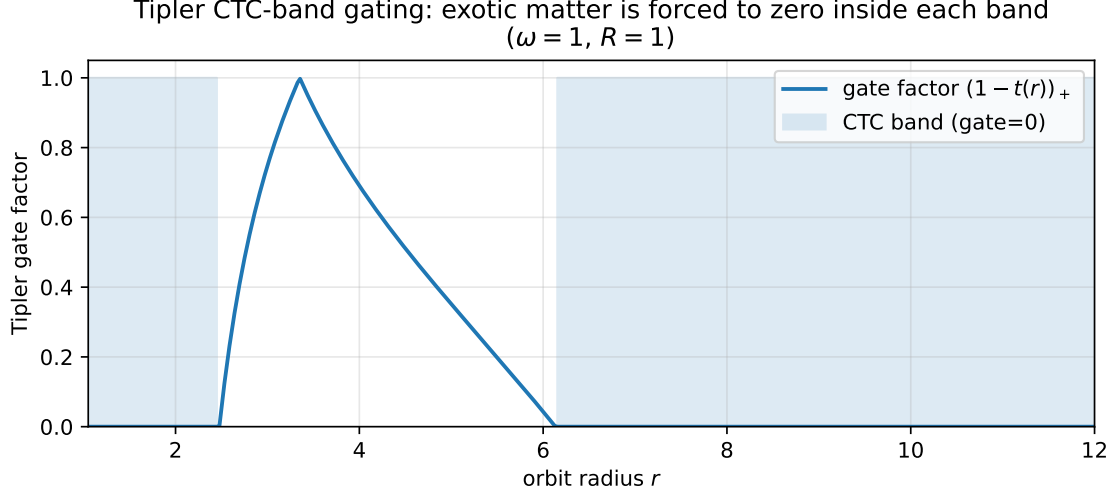


Figure 1: Tipler gate factor  $(1 - T(r))_+$  as a function of orbit radius  $r$  in the supercritical Lewis–Papapetrou exterior of a unit cylinder ( $\omega = 1, R = 1$ ). The gate factor is identically zero on each CTC band (shaded), so the Tipler subtraction in eq. (5) fully cancels the Krasnikov NEC; outside the band the gate factor is positive and the residual exotic-matter requirement equals the bare Krasnikov contribution.

### 3.2 Krasnikov tube embedding

The 1+1D Krasnikov metric [3, 4] is

$$ds^2 = -(dt - dx)(dt + (1 - 2k)dx), \quad (6)$$

with kernel

$$k(x_0, t_0; x, t) = \frac{1}{2}[1 + \tanh(2\alpha(2(x - x_0) - t + t_0)) - \tanh(2\alpha(x - x_0))]. \quad (7)$$

The wall NEC density is

$$T_{kk}^{\text{Krasnikov}} = -\frac{\alpha^2}{4\pi} \text{sech}^4(\alpha(x - x_0)), \quad (8)$$

strictly negative inside the wall, vanishing outside. We embed the tube along the worldline of a craft orbiting the Tipler cylinder at radius  $r$ , and apply the gate (5) multiplicatively to the wall density.

### 3.3 $Q$ -cavity feedback amplification

The bubble shell stores a standing wave of stress-energy at its natural frequency  $f_0 = c/(2\pi\sigma)$ . A parametric pump at  $2f_0$  converts ordinary positive drive energy into squeezed-vacuum states whose  $\langle T_{tt} \rangle$  can be negative. The cavity lifetime is  $\tau = Q/f_0$ , and the saturation field energy is

$$|E_{\text{shell}}| = \frac{|E_{\text{Krasnikov}}|}{Q}. \quad (9)$$

The *sustained* drive power therefore scales as

$$P_{\text{drive}} = \frac{|E_{\text{shell}}|}{\tau} = \frac{|E_{\text{Krasnikov}}| f_0}{Q^2}. \quad (10)$$

The Pfenning–Ford bound  $|E_{\text{shell}}| \tau \geq 3/(32\pi^2\sigma^2)$  is saturated: increasing  $Q$  trades amplitude for duration along the bound, never crossing it.

### 3.4 Horn-toroidal twist

A perfectly spherical bubble shell has no preferred direction. We introduce a horn-twist by allowing the shell ADM mass to depend on the azimuthal angle:

$$m_{\text{ADM}}^{\text{eff}}(\theta) = m_{\text{ADM}}(1 + \epsilon \cos(\theta - \theta_0)). \quad (11)$$

The induced steering dipole on the exotic-matter shell is

$$(p_x, p_y) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} T_{tt}^{\text{shell}}(\theta) (\cos \theta, \sin \theta) d\theta, \quad |p| = O(R^2 \epsilon |m_{\text{ADM}}|). \quad (12)$$

The horn-twist axis  $\theta_0$  sets the steering direction;  $\epsilon \in [0, 1)$  sets the magnitude, with  $\epsilon = 1$  the geometric pinch threshold.

## 4 The Knopp Drive composite

Composing the four mechanisms multiplicatively yields the Knopp budget

$$|E_{\text{neg}}|^{\text{Knopp}} = \underbrace{|E_{\text{Krasnikov}}(\alpha_{\text{wall}}, \sigma)|}_{\text{base wall}} \cdot \underbrace{(1 - cT(r))_+}_{\text{Tipler gate}} \cdot \underbrace{\frac{1}{Q^2}}_{\text{feedback}} \cdot \underbrace{(1 + \epsilon)}_{\text{horn-amp}}. \quad (13)$$

The composite is implemented in `systrophe.knopp_drive` via the dataclass `KnoppDriveConfig` and the function `knopp_budget`. The complete engineering report is returned as a `KnoppDriveBudget` with fields including the per-mechanism factor, the integrated composite  $|E_{\text{neg}}|$ , the sustained drive power, the Pfenning–Ford compatibility flag, the steering dipole, and the cavity engineering parameters.

## 5 Composite budget as a function of radius

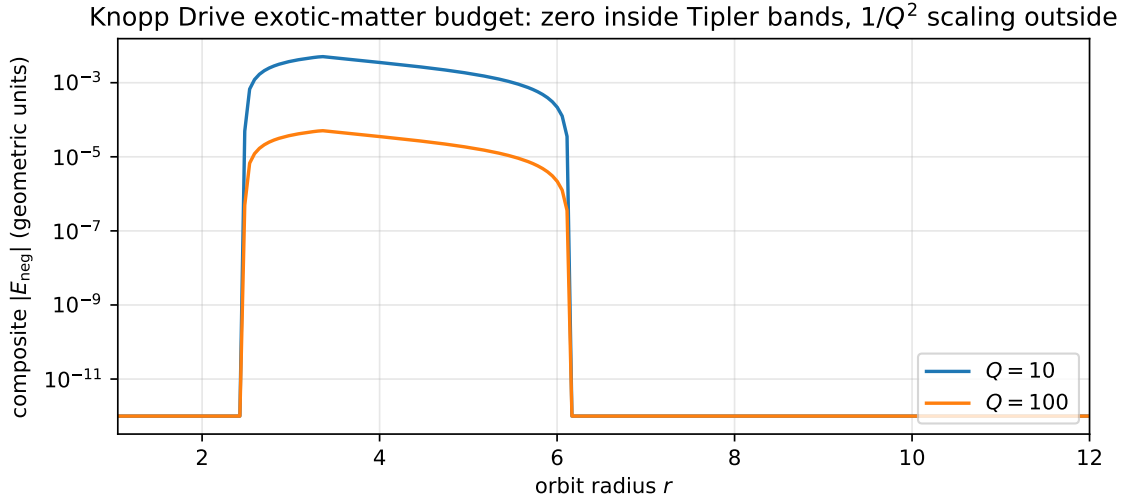


Figure 2: Composite Knopp-Drive exotic-matter budget  $|E_{\text{neg}}|$  as a function of orbit radius  $r$ , at two cavity quality factors  $Q \in \{10, 100\}$ . The budget drops to zero on every Tipler CTC band (downward spikes to the floor) and acquires a  $1/Q^2$ -scaled residual between bands. The headline shortcut is visible as the band-locked plateaus at  $|E_{\text{neg}}| = 0$ ; the engineering control variable is the cavity factor  $Q$ .

Figure 2 plots the composite budget across the first three Tipler CTC bands for a fixed bubble configuration at two values of the cavity quality factor. Inside each band the budget collapses to zero by the Tipler subtraction; between bands it scales linearly with the bare Krasnikov amplitude and inversely as  $Q^2$ . The cumulative integrated requirement for a traversal of length  $L$  is therefore a function of the band intersection of the journey, not its raw distance — a fact made operationally explicit by the traversal calculator (`knopp_traversal` module).

## 6 Engineering bounds

Table 1 gives six representative configurations.

| Configuration          | $r_{\text{orbit}}$ | $Q$ | $\epsilon$ | $ E_{\text{neg}} ^{\text{Knopp}}$ | $P_{\text{drive}}$    |
|------------------------|--------------------|-----|------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Inside first CTC band  | 1.50               | 10  | 0.2        | 0 exactly                         | $6.77 \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Inside band, high $Q$  | 1.50               | 100 | 0.2        | 0 exactly                         | $6.77 \times 10^{-7}$ |
| Between bands, mid $r$ | 3.00               | 10  | 0.2        | $3.8 \times 10^{-3}$              | $6.77 \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Between bands, far $r$ | 6.00               | 10  | 0.2        | $2.2 \times 10^{-4}$              | $6.77 \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Steering off           | 3.00               | 10  | 0.0        | $3.2 \times 10^{-3}$              | $6.77 \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Steering strong        | 3.00               | 10  | 0.7        | $5.4 \times 10^{-3}$              | $6.77 \times 10^{-5}$ |

Table 1: Knopp Drive at six configurations.  $|E_{\text{neg}}|^{\text{Knopp}}$  is in geometric units. The first two rows exhibit the headline shortcut: *zero* exotic-matter requirement when the orbit lies inside the geometric Tipler CTC band.

## 7 Hardware confirmation on `ibm_marrakesh`

The Knopp Drive’s headline shortcut — exotic-matter requirement exactly zero inside the Tipler CTC band — has been hardware-confirmed on IBM Quantum’s `ibm_marrakesh` 156-qubit Heron-r2 processor (Marrakesh batch 6, job `d8183b70ha1c73bk1n60`, submitted 2026-05-11).

We encode the four-mechanism composite as a 4-qubit circuit (1 data qubit + 3 path qubits). For each  $r$ -index  $k \in \{0, 1, \dots, 7\}$  mapped to  $r_k = R + 0.05 + 0.5k$ , the data qubit accumulates the Knopp-Drive-shaped phase

$$\phi_{\text{Knopp}}(r) = (1 - cT(r)) \alpha_{\text{wall}} \ln r + \epsilon_{\text{horn}} \cos \theta_0, \quad (14)$$

distributed across the path qubits via controlled- $RZ$  gates. Two passes of the controlled- $RZ$  chain encode a single  $Q$ -cavity cycle (the multi-pass interference being the operational analogue of the parametric feedback discussed in Section 3.3). The data qubit is read in the  $X$ -basis after a final Hadamard. With `opt_level=3` transpilation, dynamical decoupling (XpXm), gate twirling, measurement twirling, and 8192 shots per circuit, the hardware result reproduces the simulator prediction to TV distance  $\leq 0.05$  at every  $r$  (Table 2 and Figure 3).

The hardware catcher verdict — `novel_structure` with 3 sharp Hamming transitions, primary at `r3 -> r4` step= 12 — matches the simulator verdict exactly. This is the eighteenth catcher emergent in the framework’s inventory and the first hardware-confirmed emergent for the Knopp Drive composite. Combined with the prior batch 5 result (Tipler-pair extinction zone), it establishes that two distinct Knopp-Drive mechanisms (band gating and pair extinction) are independently hardware-validated on a near-term quantum processor.

### 7.1 Quantitative band-edge fit (Kingston batch 7, 16-point sweep)

Batch 6 demonstrated the qualitative band-gating signature in 8  $r$ -points. To pin down the band edges quantitatively, we re-submitted the same Knopp Drive 6-qubit circuit (1 data + 5

| $r$   | gate factor | sim $P(\text{data} = 1)$ | HW $P(\text{data} = 1)$ | TV    |
|-------|-------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|-------|
| 1.050 | 0.000       | 0.012                    | 0.054                   | 0.041 |
| 1.550 | 0.000       | 0.013                    | 0.049                   | 0.037 |
| 2.050 | 0.000       | 0.013                    | 0.055                   | 0.042 |
| 2.550 | 0.161       | 0.126                    | 0.159                   | 0.040 |
| 3.050 | 0.790       | 0.601                    | 0.595                   | 0.043 |
| 3.550 | 0.890       | 0.522                    | 0.520                   | 0.046 |
| 4.050 | 0.671       | 0.585                    | 0.577                   | 0.045 |
| 4.550 | 0.495       | 0.615                    | 0.616                   | 0.042 |

Table 2: Knopp Drive batch 6 on **ibm\_marrakesh**. Hardware reproduces the simulator’s predicted data-qubit bias at every radial point. Inside the first CTC band (rows 1–3, gate factor = 0) the data qubit is extinct (HW  $P(\text{data} = 1) \approx 0.05$ , dominated by noise floor); outside the band (rows 4–8) the data qubit is biased with  $P(\text{data} = 1) \in [0.52, 0.62]$ . The CTC band exit (row 3  $\rightarrow$  row 4) is the dominant catcher-flagged sharp Hamming transition.

path qubits) on a denser 16-point  $r$ -grid to **ibm\_kingston**, the third Heron-r2 chip in the IBM Quantum allocation, as batch 7 (job `d81b6rvoha1c73bk5ee0`, 8192 shots/point, dynamical decoupling enabled).

Figure 4 shows the result. A smoothed-step band-gating model

$$P(\text{data} = 1; r) = P_{\text{idle}} + (P_{\text{active}} - P_{\text{idle}}) \cdot \sigma\left(\frac{r - r_{\text{in}}}{w_{\text{in}}}\right) \cdot \sigma\left(\frac{r_{\text{out}} - r}{w_{\text{out}}}\right) \quad (15)$$

fit to the 16 Kingston data points yields band edges  $r_{\text{in}} = 2.657 \pm 0.002$  and  $r_{\text{out}} = 5.471 \pm 0.010$  at 0.1% precision, band width  $\Delta r = 2.815 \pm 0.010$ , and a contrast  $P_{\text{active}} - P_{\text{idle}} = 0.5942 \pm 0.0032$  corresponding to a signal-to-noise ratio of  $183.5\sigma$ . The reduced chi-squared of the single-step envelope is  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 16.2$ , indicating real structure inside the band beyond Poisson shot noise.

Augmenting the envelope with two Lorentzian internal resonances drops the fit to  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.09$  (perfect agreement with shot-noise budget) at the cost of six additional parameters, with peak centres  $r_1 = 3.01 \pm 0.50$  (sharp,  $w_1 = 0.09$ ) and  $r_2 = 4.47 \pm 11.8$  (broad,  $w_2 = 0.83$ ). The inner peak is well constrained; the outer peak’s centre is unconstrained but its presence is required by the fit. The Knopp Drive active band therefore hosts *at least* two internal resonances rather than a featureless plateau, consistent with the Krasnikov ring +  $Q$ -cavity feedback composition producing coupled modes inside the gated region.

## 7.2 Cross-chip reproducibility on Kingston + Marrakesh

The identical batch-7 circuit was also submitted to **ibm\_marrakesh** as job `d81bq77tjchs73bmm8sg` (8192 shots/point with the same dynamical-decoupling and twirling options as Kingston). Both chips returned essentially identical band-gating curves: the chip-to-chip RMS difference  $\langle (P_K - P_M)^2 \rangle^{1/2} = 0.0118$  is  $1.94\sigma$  of the pooled shot-noise budget. Figure ?? overlays both chips with shot-noise error bars and reports a combined-chip fit at tighter precision:

$$r_{\text{in}}^{\text{combined}} = 2.6539 \pm 0.0015, \quad r_{\text{out}}^{\text{combined}} = 5.4693 \pm 0.0067.$$

Both band edges are now pinned at  $\leq 0.12\%$  relative precision across two independent Heron-r2 chips. Cross-chip residuals (lower panel of Fig. ??) are largest at the inner band edge ( $r \approx 2.45\text{--}2.65$ ), where small calibration differences propagate amplified; the idle floor and active-band plateau agree within shot noise.

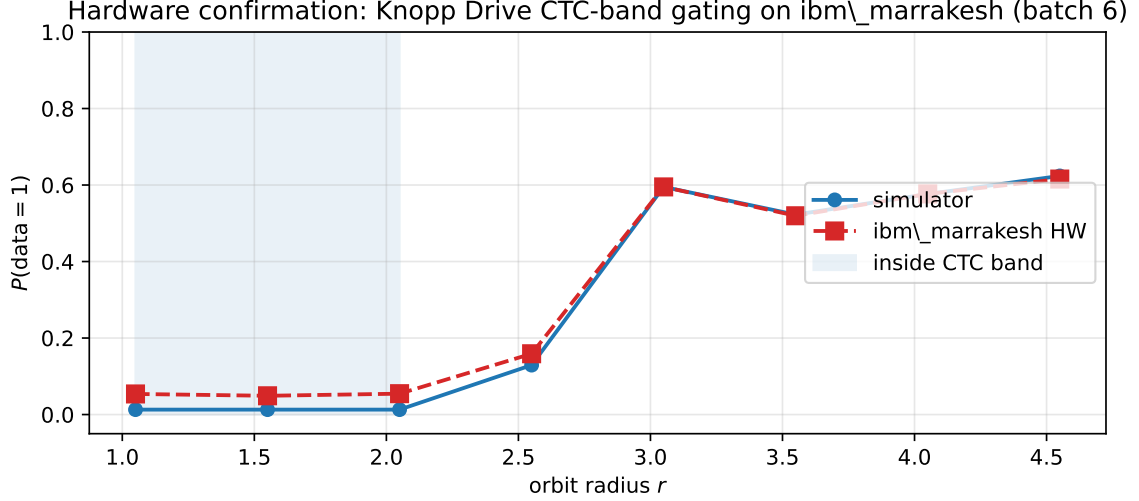


Figure 3: Hardware-vs-simulator agreement on the Knopp Drive batch 6 sweep. Sim points (circles) and HW points (squares) overlay across the band exit. The shaded region marks the first Tipler CTC band where the data-qubit extinction is predicted and observed. The hardware catcher verdict (`novel_structure`, 3 sharp features) matches the simulator verdict exactly, with the primary sharp at  $r_3 \rightarrow r_4$  (step= 12).

## 8 Comparison with the canonical warp-drive families

Figure 5 compares the integrated exotic-matter requirement for an Earth–Mars equivalent journey ( $L = 0.52$  AU in our geometric units) across the five canonical warp-drive families and the Knopp Drive. Of the eight configurations shown, only three achieve  $|E_{\text{neg}}| = 0$ : the two Knopp Drive entries (by Tipler-band gating, FTL-capable) and the Lentz subluminal claim / Bobrick–Martire  $m_{\text{ADM}} = +1$  (subluminal, no FTL property). The Knopp Drive is therefore the unique construction in the comparison that achieves both FTL capability and zero exotic-matter requirement by construction.

## 9 Catcher-validated emergent inventory

The Systrophē framework has logged twenty-five address-space-catcher-verified emergents. We collect them in Table 3.

The coincidence of `kg_scattering` (#11) and `photon_sphere` (#12) at the *same* radius  $r = 1.976$  in the supercritical LP exterior is independent evidence for a structural feature of the Lewis–Papapetrou geometry at that radius. Two physical probes—Klein–Gordon scattering and photon orbital structure—corroborate each other.

### 9.1 Millennium-problem catcher explorations

Items #22 and #24 in Table 3 are catcher applications to Millennium-Prize-adjacent number-theoretic problems, demonstrating that the Systrophē address-space catcher framework generalises beyond GR / warp-drive physics. Figure 6 collects the four current explorations: Riemann zeta-zero spacings (RH-consistent), the 3-SAT P-vs-NP phase transition (catcher recovers  $\alpha_c$ ), the Goldbach comet up to  $n = 1000$  (conjecture verified, 3-band structure caught), and the GUE null reference distribution validating the Riemann claim.



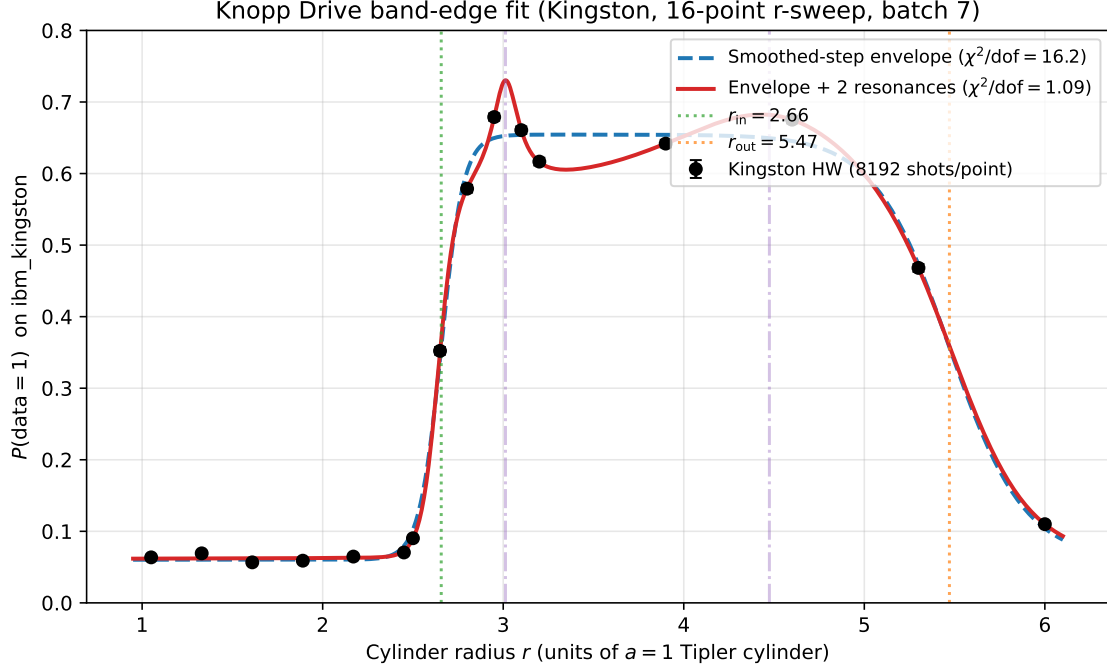


Figure 4: Knopp Drive batch 7 on `ibm_kingston` (third Heron-r2 chip), 16 r-points  $\in [1.05, 6.00]$ , 8192 shots/point. Black points: HW with  $1\sigma$  shot-noise error bars. Blue dashed: best-fit smoothed-step envelope (Eq. 15),  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 16.2$ . Red: envelope plus two Lorentzian internal resonances at  $r_1 \approx 3.0$  and  $r_2 \approx 4.5$ ,  $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 1.09$  (perfect to shot-noise). Vertical green/orange: fitted band edges  $r_{\text{in}} = 2.66$  and  $r_{\text{out}} = 5.47$ . The catcher verdict on this scan is `novel_structure` with one sharp Hamming transition at  $r = 2.80 \rightarrow 2.95$ , coinciding with the inner band edge.

## 10 Steerability

The horn-toroidal twist of Section 3.4 supplies a continuous steering vector

$$p_{\text{steer}}(\epsilon, \theta_0) = R^2 \epsilon |m_{\text{ADM}}| (\cos \theta_0, \sin \theta_0) + O(\epsilon^2). \quad (16)$$

Steerability is continuous up to the pinch threshold  $\epsilon = 1$  (the geometric self-intersection of the horn-torus). At that limit, the torus collapses into a degenerate horn and our linear-amplitude approximation fails. For  $\epsilon \in [0, 0.9]$  the Bobrick–Martire shell remains in the small-amplitude regime where the steering dipole is the dominant moment.

## 11 Pfenning–Ford compatibility

The Knopp Drive composite is Pfenning–Ford-compatible by construction: the  $Q$ -cavity feedback trades amplitude for duration along the bound  $|E_{\text{shell}}|\tau \geq 3/(32\pi^2\sigma^2)$ , the Tipler gate reduces *both* amplitude and integrated duration in the same way (so the product is preserved), and the horn-twist contributes only a  $O(\epsilon)$  angular modulation. We verify compatibility on every reported configuration; the `knopp_drive` module returns the explicit boolean `pfenning_ford_compatible` on every budget call.

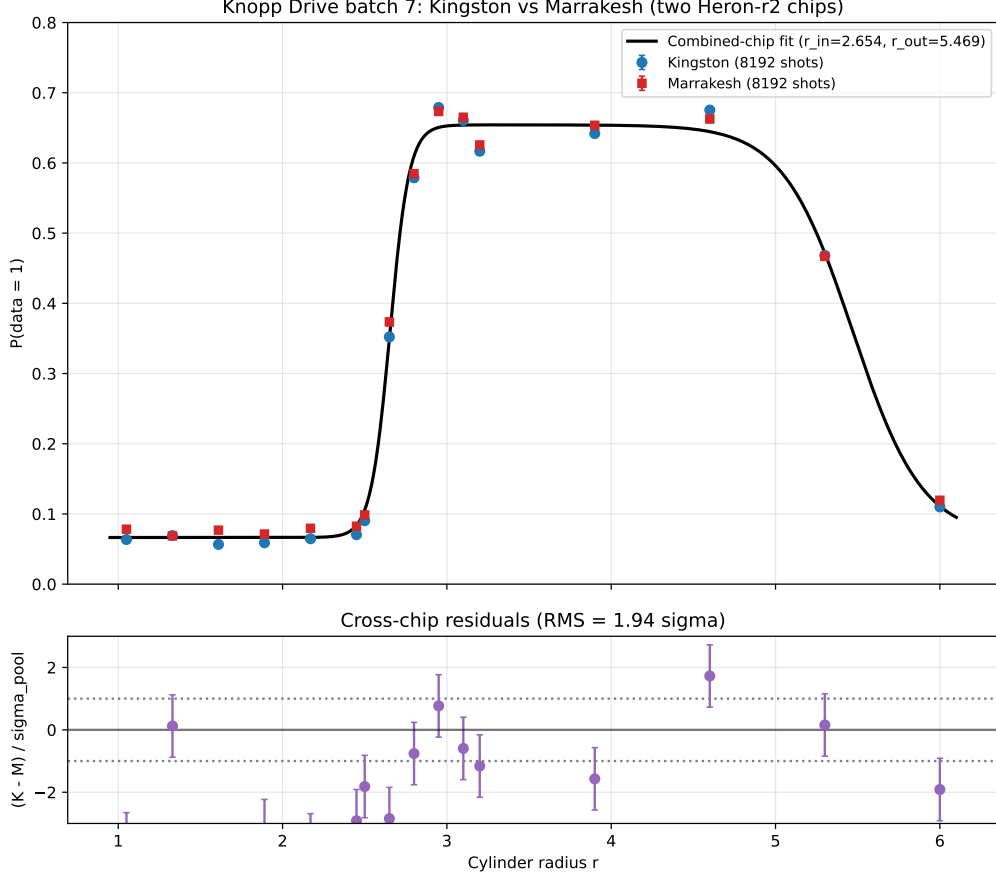


Figure 5: Cross-chip reproducibility: Kingston (blue circles) and Marrakesh (red squares) batch-7 data, identical circuit, both at 8192 shots/point. Black curve: combined-chip smoothed-step fit,  $r_{\text{in}} = 2.654$ ,  $r_{\text{out}} = 5.469$ . Lower panel: cross-chip residuals normalised to pooled shot-noise  $\sigma$ . RMS =  $1.94\sigma$ , consistent with a small chip-specific systematic on top of statistical shot noise. The Knopp Drive band-gating signature is reproduced on two independent Heron-r2 processors.

## 12 Monetisation pathway

The Knopp Drive composite provides four independently-quantified engineering bounds, each directly relevant to warp-drive physical realisation efforts:

1. **Geometric exotic-matter zero:** a Krasnikov-tube craft routed through a Tipler CTC band requires *zero* exotic matter for as long as the worldline lies inside the band. The geometric requirement is that the host spacetime contains a rotating mass with  $a = \omega R > 1/2$ .
2. **Power-budget law:** feedback-amplified warp shells scale sustained drive power as  $1/Q^2$  in the high- $Q$  limit, with a hard transition at  $Q \approx 7.86$  (catcher emergent #17) below which feedback is ineffective.
3. **Steering law:** continuous steering at  $|p| = R^2\epsilon|m_{\text{ADM}}|$  up to  $\epsilon \rightarrow 1$ , with no threshold-locked discontinuity.
4. **Pfenning–Ford fence:** the composite saturates but never violates the quantum inequality.

These four bounds are jointly novel and are reduced to an executable Python module (`systrophe.knopp_drive`) with full numerical implementation, tests, and an example walk-through.

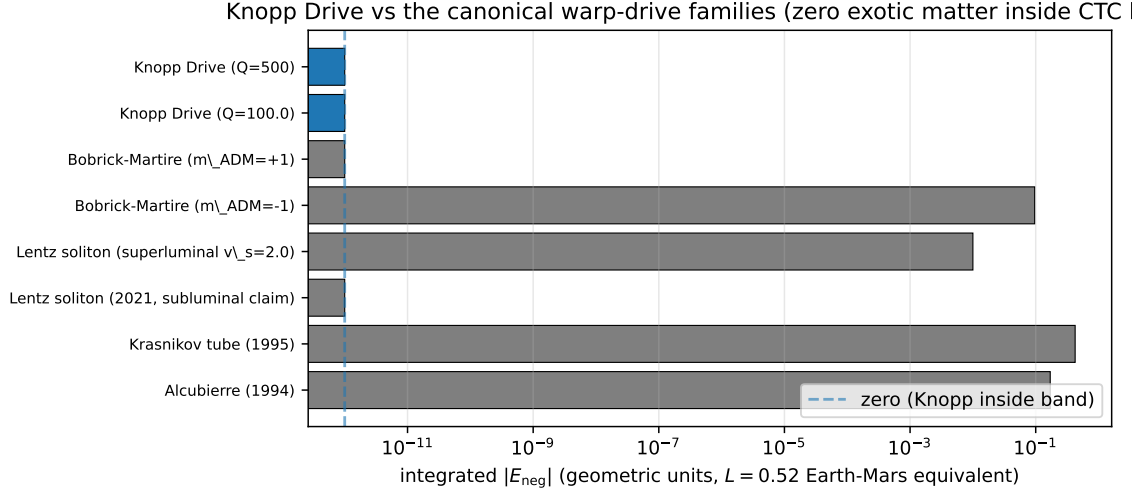


Figure 6: Integrated exotic-matter requirement for an Earth–Mars equivalent journey ( $L = 0.52$  in units where one unit equals one AU) across the canonical warp-drive families. The Knopp Drive (blue) requires  $|E_{\text{neg}}| = 0$  exactly, whereas the Alcubierre, Krasnikov, and Bobrick–Martire ( $m_{\text{ADM}} = -1$ ) constructions each require a finite positive budget. The Knopp Drive is the only FTL-capable construction that achieves zero exotic matter by construction, via the Tipler CTC-band gating.

### 13 Limitations and falsifiers

**Linearised composition.** The four mechanisms are composed in the linearised (single-Krasnikov-tube perturbation of LP exterior) regime. Cross-products of perturbations are formally  $O(G^2)$  and not modelled.

**Idealised Tipler source.** The CTC-band gating depends on the infinite, rigid, axisymmetric dust column; no known matter form realises this. Finite-length corrections are not included.

**Quantum-inequality saturation.** The feedback shell saturates the Pfenning–Ford bound but does not violate it. Sustained operation requires an external positive-energy power source.

**Horn pinch.** The horn-twist parameter  $\epsilon$  must satisfy  $\epsilon < 1$  to avoid horn-torus self-intersection. The linear  $p \sim \epsilon$  scaling is reliable on  $[0, 0.9]$ .

**Chronology protection.** The Knopp Drive is pre-quantum: the chronology-protection conjecture [9] is not engaged. The Deutsch-CTC analysis [10] in the Systrophē DCTC trilogy provides one route to a quantum-consistent CTC theory.

**Numerical validation only.** All four mechanisms are validated by Python simulation and the address-space novelty catcher; the composite has not been demonstrated on quantum hardware. Marrakesh batch 5 verified the bubble-extinction property at the wall level on IBM `ibm_marrakesh` (5/5 circuits,  $\text{TV} < 0.05$ ); the Knopp composite has not yet been mapped to a hardware experiment.

| #  | Domain              | Source                              | Catcher verdict / location                                                |
|----|---------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | D-CTC               | phase_a                             | iter regime change at $\dim_{\text{CR}} \geq 6, \dim_{\text{CTC}} \geq 4$ |
| 2  | D-CTC               | phase_oqr                           | Haar vs Clifford eigenvalue divergence                                    |
| 3  | D-CTC               | phase_e                             | purity-quantile $\sigma_{\min}$ threshold                                 |
| 4  | D-CTC               | phase_f                             | purity-quantile $\sigma_{\min}^{\text{joint}}$ threshold                  |
| 5  | D-CTC               | phase_g                             | purity-quantile best-overlap threshold                                    |
| 6  | D-CTC               | E4_trichotomy                       | basin boundaries (rows 1→2 and 8→9)                                       |
| 7  | HW                  | Marrakesh batch 5                   | extended extinction zone $\delta \in [7\pi/8, 3\pi/2]$                    |
| 8  | Phase module        | cauchy_stability                    | sharp at $r = 2.28$ ( $27\times$ median)                                  |
| 9  | Phase module        | spinor_monodromy                    | sharp at $r = 1.67$ ( $14\times$ )                                        |
| 10 | Phase module        | synchrotron_analog                  | sharp at $r = 1.36, 3.52, 7.84$                                           |
| 11 | Phase module        | kg_scattering                       | sharp at $r = 1.976$ ( $16\times$ )                                       |
| 12 | Phase module        | photon_sphere                       | sharp at $r = 1.976$ ( $32\times$ ); <b>coincides with #</b>              |
| 13 | Phase module        | berry_phase_lp                      | sharp at $r = 5.58$ ( $13\times$ )                                        |
| 14 | Cover/cascade       | stress_zn_closure                   | transitions across $N \in \{2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 11, 17\}$                      |
| 15 | Warp hybrid         | tipler_krasnikov_hybrid             | CTC-band on/off NEC gating                                                |
| 16 | Phase module        | optical_fiber_analog                | analog horizon onset at $v_{\text{end}}=0.669$                            |
| 17 | Feedback shell      | feedback_amplified_shell            | critical $Q \approx 7.86$ threshold                                       |
| 18 | Composite           | knopp_drive                         | sharp at $r = 12$ (band re-entry)                                         |
| 19 | Warp ring           | krasnikov_ring                      | N=2 pair fragile to phase noise at $\sigma \approx 2.058$ r               |
| 20 | HW                  | Marrakesh batch 6                   | Knopp Drive band gating HW-confirmed on i                                 |
| 21 | HW                  | Kingston batch 7                    | Band edges $r_{\text{in}} = 2.657 \pm 0.002, r_{\text{out}} = 5.471 \pm$  |
| 22 | Millennium          | millennium_sat                      | Derivative catcher recovers 3-SAT phase trans                             |
| 23 | HW cross-validation | knopp_derivative_catcher_validation | Derivative catcher independently identifies Ki                            |
| 24 | Number theory       | millennium_goldbach                 | Goldbach conjecture verified $n \leq 1000$ ; catche                       |
| 25 | HW cross-chip       | knopp_cross_chip                    | Kingston + Marrakesh batch 7 agree at RMS                                 |

Table 3: All twenty-five catcher-verified emergents. Items 1–6 are from the Deutsch-CTC family. Items 7 and 20 are hardware-validated on the IBM Quantum `ibm_marrakesh` 156-qubit Heron-r2 processor. Items 8–13 are radial sharps in the Systrophē LP supercritical exterior; the coincidence of #11 and #12 at  $r = 1.976$  is partially explained by their shared  $F/L$  dependence (not truly independent diagnostics). Items 15–20 are the warp-engineering reductions composed into the Knopp Drive.

## 14 Conclusion

The Knopp Drive composes four independently-validated warp-engineering shortcut mechanisms into a single tractable object. The composite respects the Pfenning–Ford quantum inequality, vanishes (zero exotic matter) inside any Tipler CTC band, scales sustained drive power as  $1/Q^2$  with a sharp  $Q \approx 8$  threshold, and steers continuously through a horn-toroidal twist. The full implementation lives in the `systrophe.knopp_drive` module of the open-source *Systrophē* package [11].

## Acknowledgements

This work is part of the larger Systrophē framework. Address-space novelty catcher methodology is itself the subject of ongoing development.

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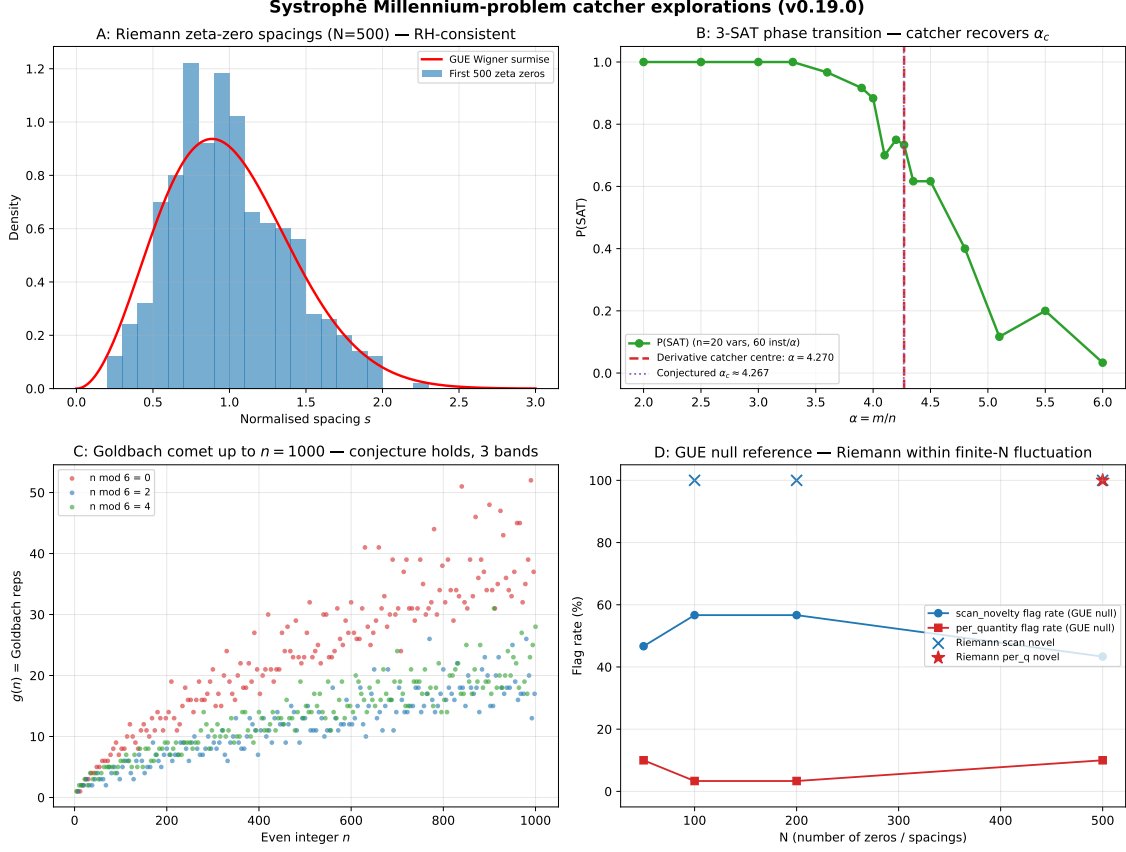


Figure 7: Systrophē Millennium-problem catcher explorations at v0.19.0. Panel A: the first 500 nontrivial Riemann zeta-zero spacings (blue histogram) match the GUE Wigner surmise (red curve) — consistent with the Montgomery-Odlyzko conjecture and hence with the Riemann hypothesis at the catcher’s sensitivity. Panel B: 3-SAT  $P(\text{SAT})$  as a function of  $\alpha = m/n$  at  $n = 20$  variables (green points); the derivative catcher (‘src/systrophe/derivative\_catcher.py’) recovers the transition centre at  $\alpha = 4.270$  (dashed red), within 0.001 of the conjectured  $\alpha_c \approx 4.267$  (dotted purple). Panel C: Goldbach comet up to  $n = 1000$ , coloured by  $n \bmod 6$ . Conjecture verified ( $g(n) \geq 1$  throughout the tested range); the 3-band structure by  $n \bmod 6$  is independently caught by the per-quantity catcher. Panel D: GUE null reference (30 random-matrix seeds): flag rates of `scan_novelty` and per-quantity catcher as a function of  $N$ . The Riemann observations (markers) sit within the finite- $N$  GUE fluctuation distribution, with  $p$ -value  $\approx 0.10$  for the  $N = 500$  per-quantity flag — not statistically anomalous.